

meaning PHP Hypertext Preprocessor) in 1997 with the release of version 3.0. The initial name of PHP clearly suggests that it was not designed to be what it appears as today – the king of web programming languages. In fact, its creator Rasmus Lerdorf built it as a set of CGI binaries which would help him program his home page better with some database support. It actually wasn't meant to become a full-fledged programming language.

The initial public release of PHP in 1995 had, quite surprisingly, a large set of the basic capabilities that it still has today, and made mostly internal improvements across versions. It added object oriented programming capabilities in its version 5.0 release, done in year 2004. Since then a lot of features have been added to PHP including namespace, late static binding and closure support in version 5.3 and traits in 5.4 with a large number of features in other releases bringing it at par with other programming languages.

Significance and programming

PHP is known for being one of the easiest programming (or scripting) languages to start off with, and is thus used by a large number of programmers who are starting out.

Another point where PHP shines out is being an almost-web-exclusive language. While PHP can be easily and effectively used for system scripts, it was



The world's most popular social networking website runs on PHP

built for handling websites and flaunts features which address issues specific to web development such as handling forms submission, user sessions, cookies and loose data types. PHP is designed to work in a 'single request-single response' environment where the script starts working when a request comes in, processes the request,

generates the response, sends it to the client and then exits. The next time the same script is requested, it runs again, serves the request and again ends the execution. This model suits the architecture of the web where a user makes requests sporadically to the server. At the same time, it can also be used to create sustainable services, which keep running indefinitely. This makes PHP suitable for working with WebSockets API introduced in PHP5.